DMC course: Week 3

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Homework

1. Watch *The Matrix* movie, written and directed by the Wachowskis, 2h16m

- $3.99 to rent on YouTube. Need to create a free YouTube login.
- $3.99 to rent, $14.99 to buy on Amazon Prime Video. Need an Amazon Prime account.



2. Read the essay The Comfortable Prison: The Matrix and the Philosophers

3. Read the essay No One Is Coming: The Matrix and the Rest of Us

Questions to Guide Reflection

Questions in Preface Section on *The Matrix* , Analysis of Societal Control)

1. Who or what is controlling society?
2. How is it being controlled?

Questions in The Comfortable Prison: The Matrix and the Philosophers

1. Where does the film fit in our arc?
2. Who or what is controlling society, and how?
3. What does defiance look like when control no longer feels like control?
4. Am I contributing to, or being swept up in, our collectively "checking out"?

5. Do those who would give up essential Freedom, to purchase a little temporary Comfort, deserve either Freedom or Comfort?
6. If there is no red pill, what are the rest of us supposed to do?
7. Baudrillard says there is no "real world" to wake up into. Is he right, or is there still something real underneath the simulation?
8. The film keeps Plato's structure of a real world behind the illusion. Is that a flaw, as Baudrillard thought, or a strength?
9. Is Deleuze's picture of control, modulation without walls, a better description of our world than Orwell's Big Brother? Or do we live with both?

Questions in No One Is Coming: The Matrix and the Rest of Us

1. If there is no red pill, what are the rest of us supposed to do?
2. In all of these stories, isn't the essence of the struggle maintaining, or finding, one's own humanity?
3. **Fear or desire?** Which controls you more these days: the news that frightens you, or the screens that please you? Can you tell them apart?
4. **Your own Cypher moments.** When have you chosen the comfortable version of things, knowing it wasn't quite real? Was that always a bad choice?
5. **What keeps you human?** What do you do, or refuse to do, that a system built to predict and please you would have trouble absorbing?
6. **Waiting for a savior.** Do you find yourself hoping for a leader, a technology, or an event that will fix things? What would it mean to give up that hope without giving up?
7. **Circuit breakers.** What are yours? A walk without your phone, a conversation with someone who disagrees with you, a book nobody recommended?

Week3 Class Presentation

- links will be provide after class is held